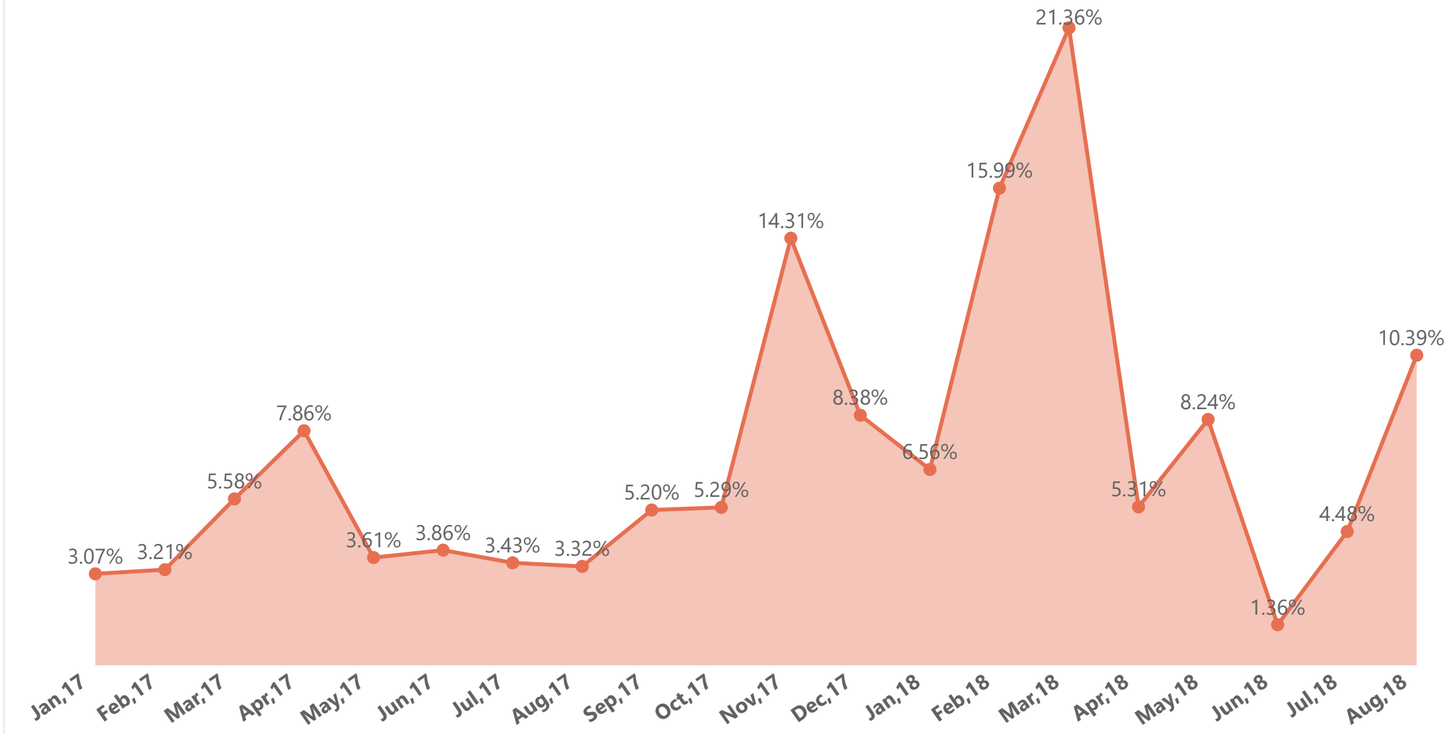
# Olist: How Delivery Delays Affect Customer Reviews

| Total Orders | Late % | Avg Review | Avg Delivery Days |
|---|---|---|---|
| 96,203 | 8.13% | 4.16 | 12 |

## Late Delivery Rate by Month




## Average Review Score: On Time vs Late




## Product Category

All

## Customer State

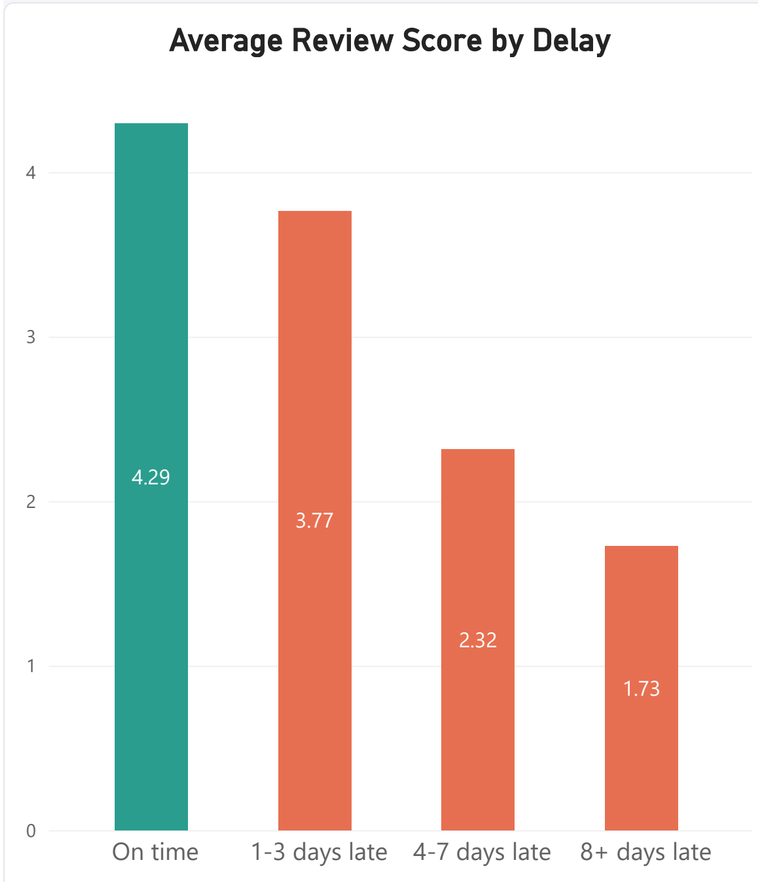
| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| AC | DF | MT | RJ | SE |
| AL | ES | PA | RN | SP |
| AM | GO | PB | RO | TO |
| AP | MA | PE | RR | |
| BA | MG | PI | RS | |
| CE | MS | PR | SC | |

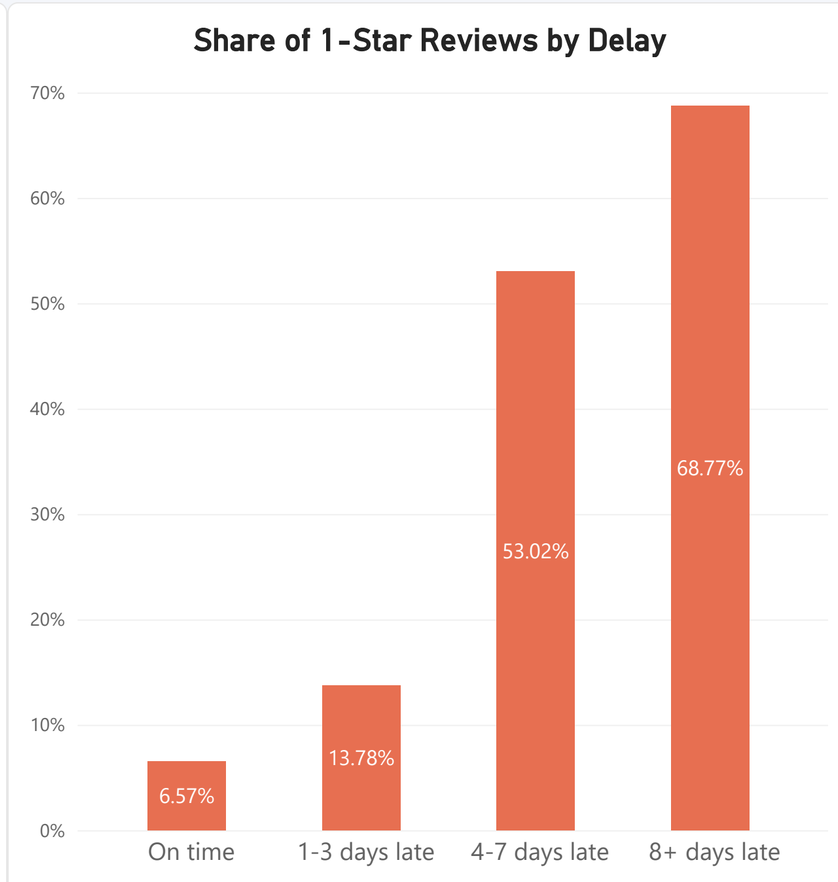
## Year

2017

2018

# Delay Impact on Customer Satisfaction




**Review Gap**

**1.73**

| Delay Bucket | Orders | Avg Review | 1-Star % |
|---|---|---|---|
| On time | 88,381 | 4.29 | 6.57% |
| 1-3 days late | 2,660 | 3.77 | 13.78% |
| 4-7 days late | 1,819 | 2.32 | 53.02% |
| 8+ days late | 3,343 | 1.73 | 68.77% |
| Total | 96,203 | 4.16 | 9.75% |

**Year**

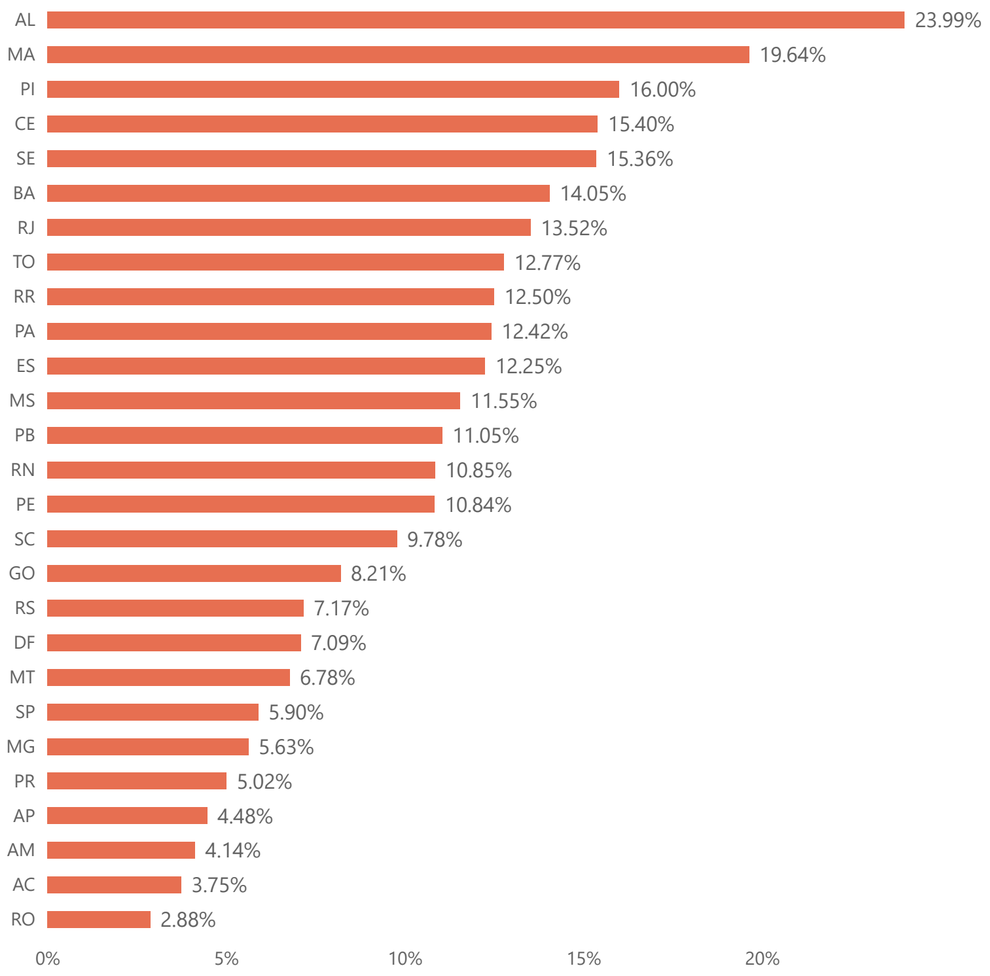
2017

2018

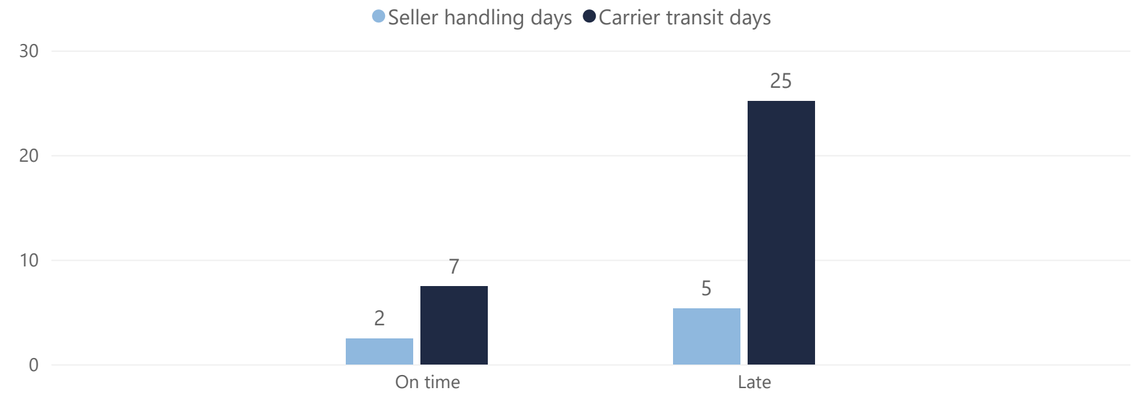
**Reviews hold up for delays of 1 to 3 days (3.77 stars), but fall sharply after 4 days (2.32). Over two-thirds of orders delayed 8 or more days get a 1-star review.**

# Root Causes of Late Deliveries

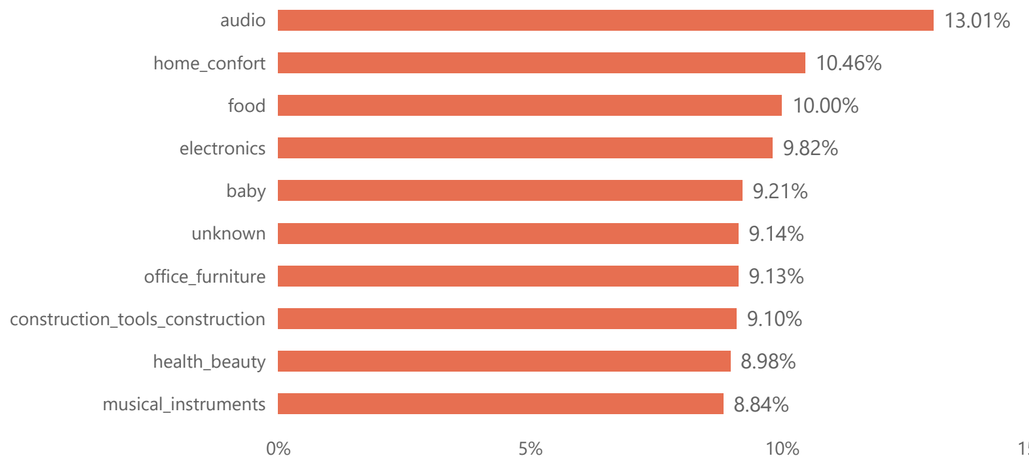
## Late Delivery Rate by Customer State




## Where the Time Goes: Seller Handling vs Carrier Transit




## Late Delivery Rate by Product Category (300+ Orders)




## Year

2017

2018

**Late orders spend about 25 days with the carrier against 7 for on-time orders, but only about 3 more days with the seller. The northeast is hit hardest (AL, MA, PI, CE, SE at 15% to 24% late, against 5.9% in SP). Category matters little: apart from audio (13%), the worst categories are within 1 to 2 points of the 8.13% average.**

# What Olist Can Do About Late Deliveries

| Review gap (on-time minus late) | Late delivery rate | Share of 1-star reviews that were late |
|---|---|---|
| 1.73 | 8.13% | 37.99% |

## Warn customers before reviews collapse

**Evidence:** Reviews hold up for delays of 1 to 3 days (3.77 stars), but fall to 2.32 after 4 days. 69% of orders delayed 8 or more days get a 1-star review.
**Action:** Send proactive delay messages, and offer compensation, once an order is about 3 days past its promised date.

## Review carrier performance first

**Evidence:** Late orders spend about 25 days in transit against 7 for on-time orders, but only about 3 more days with the seller (5 vs 2).
**Action:** Audit carrier performance before sellers, starting with the worst routes.

## Fix the northeast: honest dates and closer stock

**Evidence:** AL, MA, PI, CE and SE are 15% to 24% late, against 5.9% in SP.
**Action:** Set longer, more realistic delivery estimates for these states, and test regional fulfilment hubs or closer stock for popular items.

## Plan for peak months

**Evidence:** Late rates spike in Nov 2017 (14.31%) and again in Feb and Mar 2018 (15.99% and 21.36%).
**Action:** Add carrier capacity, and set more cautious delivery promises, before sales peaks.

**Next steps:** test distance and same-state vs cross-state shipping to confirm why the northeast is hit hardest, then compare seller performance and product weight.